

Ankit Lahoty, owner of Motion Education, conducting an online class

EDUCATION | COACHING

Photographs by PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

KOTA FACTORY, SEASON 2

WHILE ONLINE ED-TECH COMPANIES EYE THE BRICK-AND-MORTAR WORLD OF COACHING CENTRES IN THE CITY, TRADITIONAL INSTITUTES ARE EXTENDING THEIR DIGITAL ARMS TO REMAIN ON TOP OF THE GAME

By Rohit Parihar in Kota

IT'S A BUSY TIME IN RAJASTHAN'S Kota city, known as a hub of coaching centres for students aspiring to join India's top engineering and medical institutes. After two years of the Covid-19 pandemic, coaching classes are abrim with students, and competition is heating up with the entry of new players, who are pioneers in online coaching and are now venturing into the offfline space.

During lunch breaks or towards the end of evening sessions, large numbers of students wearing the uniforms of one coaching centre or the other crowd the streets, especially along a stretch of the Kota-Jhalawar highway, where some half a dozen institutes are located within walking distance of each other. The hostels, nearly all of them privately run, are full, and many more students have taken up paying guest accommodation or stay in rented rooms. The unusually high number of students in July and August is because new batches are coming in even as old batches are yet to leave due to postponed examinations during the pandemic.

Soon, graduates and post-graduates will also be seen at coaching centres in Kota and the state's capital, Jaipur, as some institutes are looking beyond engineering and medical entrance tests.